CTU TRAINING SOLUTIONS

Diploma in IT in Network Design and Administration

NET731 – Week 3 Report

Virtual Machine Deployment

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Module	NET731
Assessment	Friday Practical Assessment (FA3)
Week	Week 3 – Virtual Machine Deployment

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Introduction

The purpose of Week 3 was to deploy a virtual machine in Microsoft Azure and configure the required settings for the project. This included choosing an available low-cost VM size, configuring storage, connecting the VM to the existing network, assigning a public IP address, and enabling auto-shutdown for cost control.

According to the NET731 practical brief, Week 3 requires a virtual machine to be deployed, with the networking, public IP address, and subnet configured, and auto-shutdown enabled. The Azure for Students setup guide also advises students to keep costs low, use Standard storage, and enable auto-shutdown at 18:00 daily.

Virtual Machine Deployment

A virtual machine named CTU-NET731-VM1 was deployed in the resource group CTU-20231149-RG in the South Africa North region. The practical brief originally required a B1s virtual machine. However, when the available VM sizes were checked in the portal, Standard_B1s was not available for the Azure for Students subscription. The available alternative Standard_B2ats_v2 was selected so that the practical activity could continue.

Storage Configuration

The virtual machine was configured using Standard SSD LRS storage. This choice was made to align with the cost-control guidelines in the setup guide, which recommend the use of Standard storage tiers rather than Premium storage.

Networking Configuration

The VM was connected to the CTU-NET731-VNet virtual network and assigned to FrontendSubnet. A public IP address named CTU-NET731-VM1-ip was also created. This ensured that the VM was properly integrated into the network that was created in Week 2.

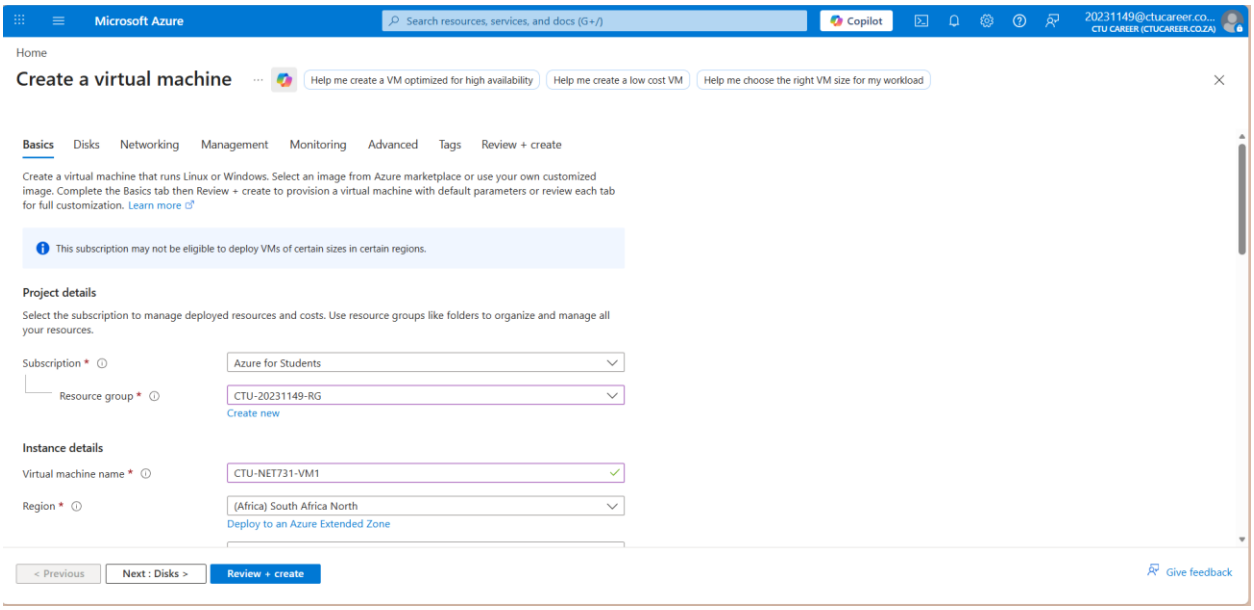
Virtual Machine Overview

After deployment, the Azure portal showed the virtual machine status as Running. The overview page confirmed the resource group, region, VM size, virtual network/subnet, and public IP details.

Auto-shutdown Configuration

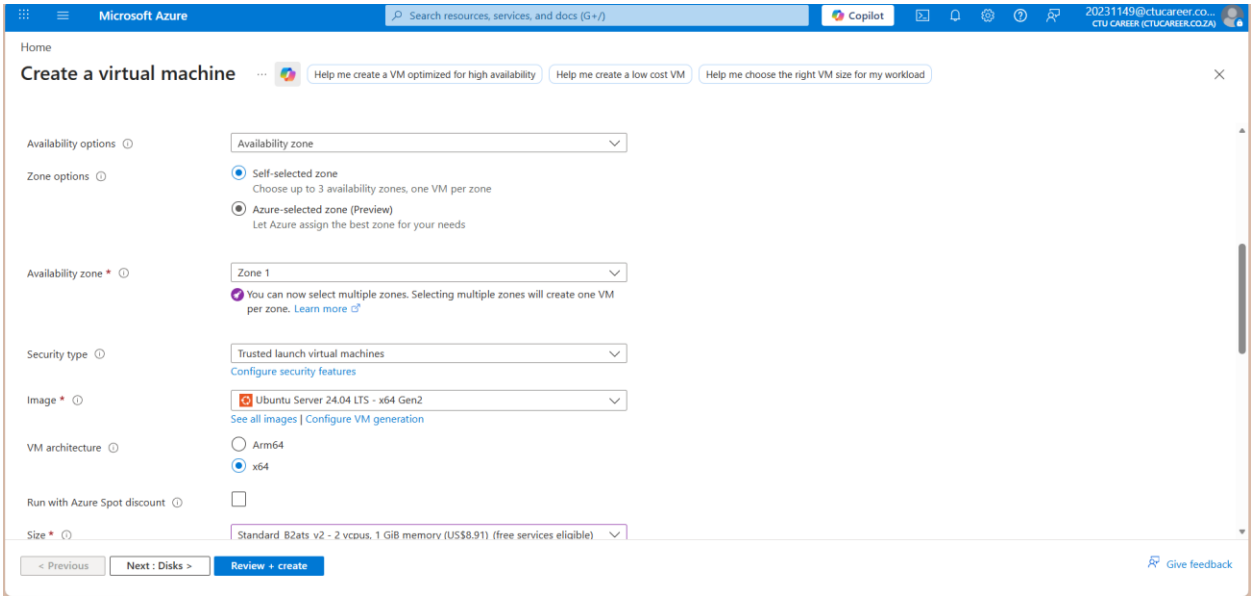
Auto-shutdown was enabled for the virtual machine and scheduled for 18:00 daily using the UTC+02:00 Harare, Pretoria time zone. This is an important cost-control measure because it prevents the VM from running unnecessarily after working hours.

Figure 1: VM basics details



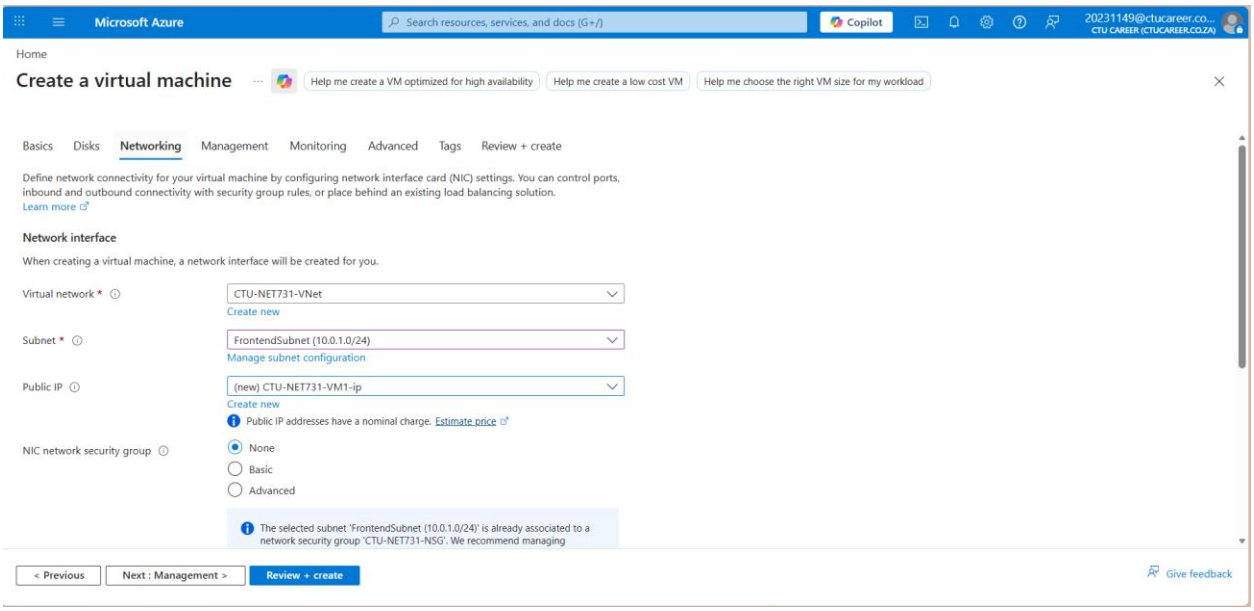
Basic VM creation details showing the subscription, resource group, VM name, and region.

Figure 2: Selected VM size



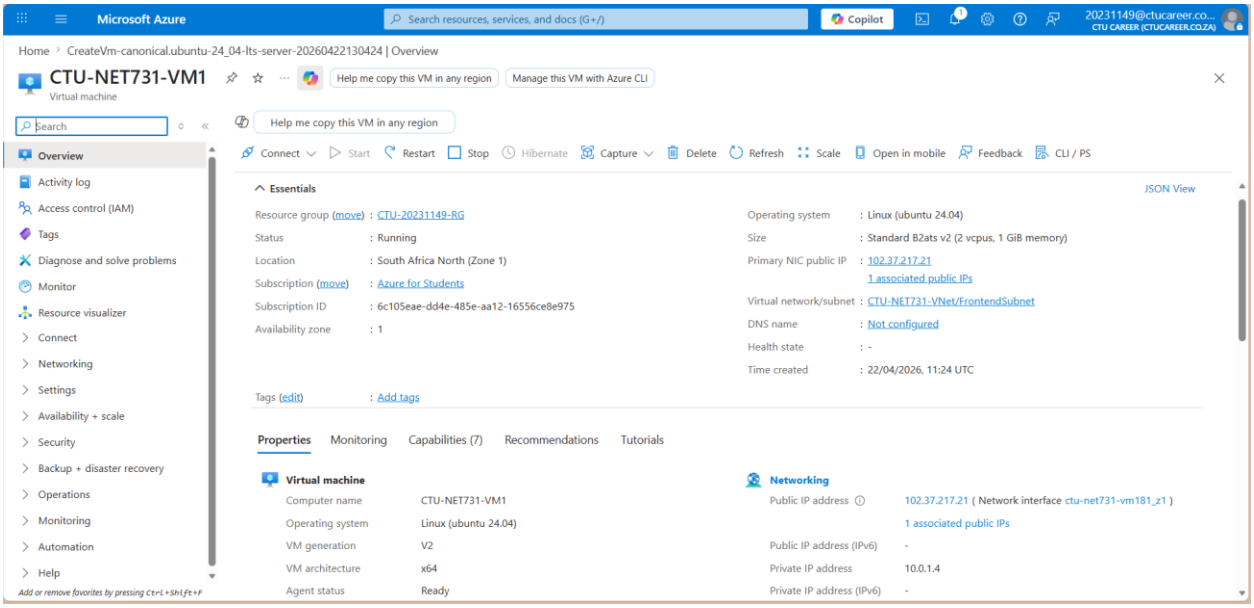
The available low-cost VM size Standard_B2ats_v2 selected after B1s was unavailable.

Figure 3: Networking configuration



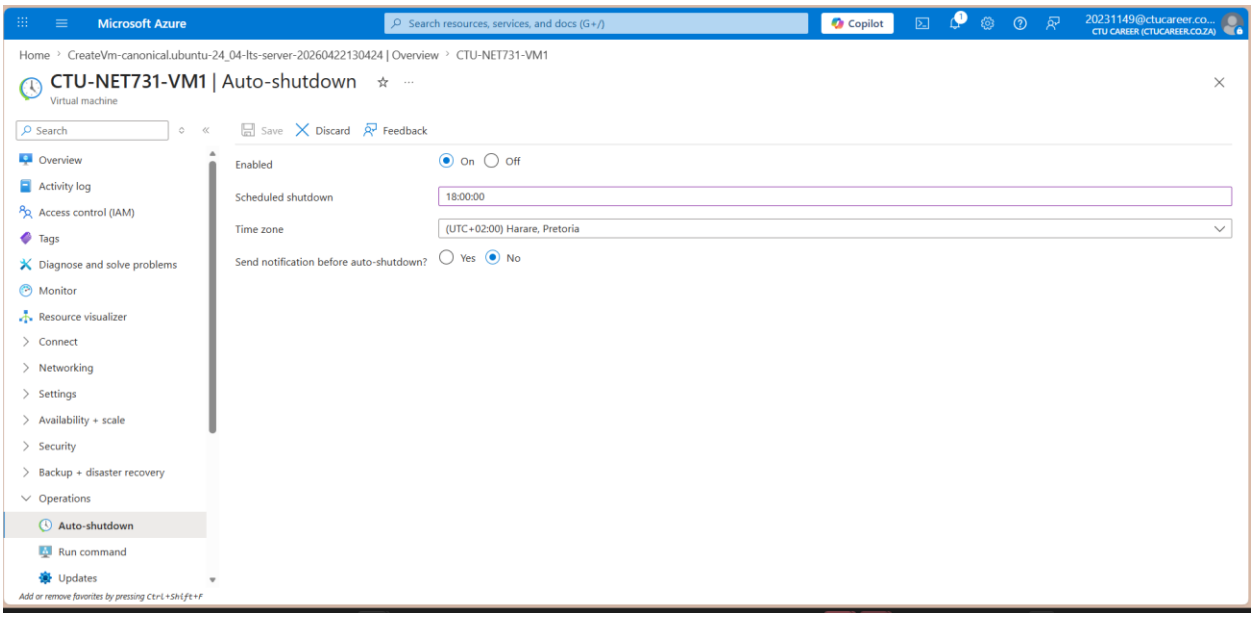
VM connected to CTU-NET731-VNet, FrontendSubnet, with a new public IP address.

Figure 4: Virtual machine overview



Overview page confirming the VM status, location, size, and network details.

Figure 5: Auto-shutdown enabled

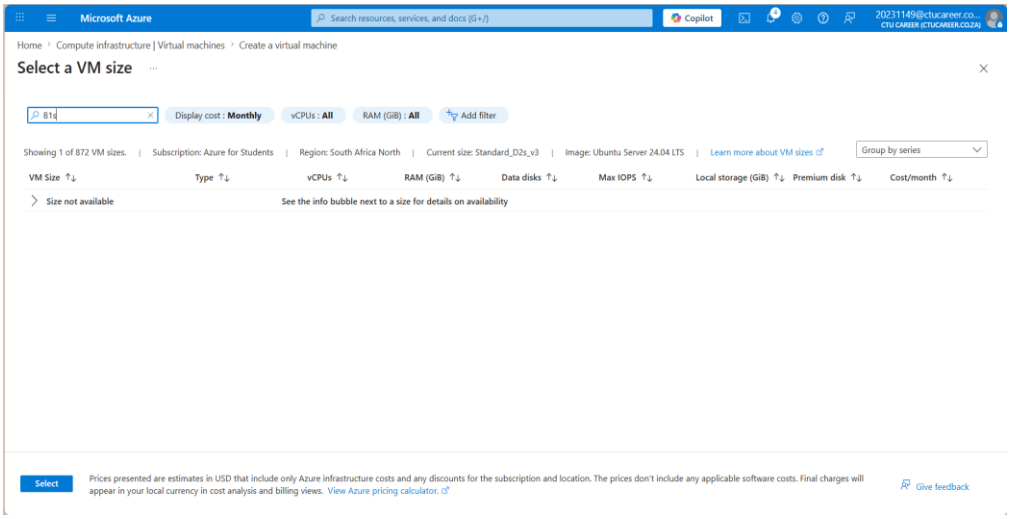


Auto-shutdown enabled and scheduled for 18:00 daily.

Conclusion

Week 3 focused on successfully deploying and configuring a virtual machine for the Azure project. Even though the required B1s size was not available, the VM was still deployed with an available low-cost alternative and configured according to the key task requirements. The VM was created with Standard SSD storage, connected to the correct network and subnet, assigned a public IP address, and configured with auto-shutdown to help control costs.

The screenshot below shows that Standard_B1s was not available in the Azure for Students subscription during VM size selection. This explains why Standard_B2ats_v2 was used instead.



References

- CTU Training Solutions (2026) NET731 Friday Practical Assessment (user-provided PDF).
- CTU Training Solutions (2026) Azure for Students Account Setup Guide (user-provided DOCX).
- Microsoft Learn (n.d.) Create a Linux virtual machine in the Azure portal.
- Microsoft Learn (n.d.) Virtual machine auto-shutdown in Azure DevTest Labs and Azure virtual machines.
- Microsoft Learn (n.d.) Azure managed disks overview.
- Microsoft Learn (n.d.) Create, change, or delete an Azure virtual network.